‘Improving Gujarati Writing’ course held at Leicester on 21st September 2025

A training course for Gujarati teachers focusing on **Improving Writing skills in Gujarati** was held on 21st September 2025 at Fullhurst Community College**,** Leicester.

Eighteen (18) teachers from a range of Gujarati schools in Leicester attended the course. The course was led by Jayantbhai Tanna with contributions from Rekhaben Patel, Shobhaben Joshi and Chetanaben Bhatt-Shah.

The course focused on using assessment criteria to improve the teaching of Writing in Gujarati for pupils of primary and GCSE classes. The first session focussed on using assessment levels in Writing for younger pupils. The second session dealt with using prescribed GCSE assessment criteria to understand how standards in Gujarati Writing for pupils might be raised. The afternoon session gave teachers an opportunity to assess pupils’ specimen Writing scripts using and applying the assessment levels for primary and GCSE criteria for older pupils. All teachers found the day to be extremely beneficial as can be seen in the completed feedback forms summarised below.

The feedback from the teachers was very positive as outlined below.

One-day Writing course for Teachers - Leicester - 21st September 2025						
Training Quality	**Strongly agree**	**Agree**	**Neutral**	**Disagree**	**Strongly disagree**	**Total**
The overall quality of training was high	15	2	0	0	0	17
The training will benefit my teaching	16	1	0	0	0	17

What was good?
Refreshed marking criteria from a different angle; extremely informative sessions; presented very well; it was excellent, amazing; levels and structure of assessment explained well; group work, discussion, opinions were very good; presenters were passionate; all very useful; relevant; opportunity for discussion with others on different topics; met colleagues from different schools; assessment levels explained very well; teaching gender linked with words useful tip; idea of all working together as a team in your school good; opportunity for marking primary and GCSE scripts was good; learning about assessment criteria very helpful; marking pupils’ sample scripts was very helpful.

What was not so good?
Joint assessment idea was very good, many thanks but time not always available in school; more resources should be made available online for all teachers to check assessment levels of pupils in Reading, Writing, Speaking and Listening.

Main action points for my teaching
Teach using the GCSE marking scheme as a guide; Apply assessment criteria in my teaching (4); will use level descriptors; will use and share tips, ideas from other teachers; will use self-assessment ideas; insist on correct and clear sounds for Gujarati letters and vowels while speaking; positive teaching; use of paragraphs in writing; encourage pupils to extend their writing; will support more schools joining in courses, meetings to get more ideas, materials and donations.

Suggestions for courses in the future
More support for GCSE themes; ideas of learning based games; how to make best use of online resources; more help with theme 5 global perspectives at GCSE; A common curriculum for all Gujarati schools in the UK; GCSE Speaking test training; more courses for GCSE; Guidelines on teaching how to improve Speaking; any kind of modern day teaching methods that are helpful for teachers to teach all for skills more effectively.

CGS General Meeting
A General Meeting of CGS was held after lunch to report on the work done in the 2024/25. It was received very positively. The meeting was also an occasion to celebrate the excellent achievement of six of our teachers at Gujarati A Level examinations in Summer 2025. They had attended twelve support sessions on Zoom conducted by Shobhaben Joshi.

1. Arunaben Patel –awarded a trophy at BAPS training session by Rekhaben Patel on 14th September 2025
2. Shrutiben Parekh – trophy award collected by Jignasha ben on Shrutiben' s behalf presented by Rekhaben Patel at BAPS training session held on 14th September 2025
3. Dipteeben Vadgama – awarded a trophy by Shobhaben Joshi at Fullhurst Community College, Leicester during CGS training on 21st September 2025
4. Darshnaben Vadgama – awarded a trophy by Shobhaben Joshi at Fullhurst Community College, Leicester during CGS training on 21st September 2025
5. Pinalben Modi - awarded a trophy by Shobhaben Joshi at Fullhurst Community College, Leicester during CGS training on 21st September 2025
6. Ruchiben Trivedi – awarded a trophy by Shobhaben Joshi at Fullhurst Community College, Leicester during CGS training on 21st September 2025

It was hoped that more teachers would attend our A Level support sessions starting in October 2025. It would then enable them to teach A Level Gujarati in their own Gujarati schools and increase the number of candidates taking A Level Gujarati examinations in the future. Many thanks to Shobhaben for conducting the support sessions and to all our donors Chandrakantbhai Mehta, Dr Amritbhai Shah, Vandanaben Joshi and Rameshbhai Odedra who contributed £550 for the examination centre expenses.

Income and Expenses
We received £15 each from 18 participants making a total of £270. We spent £165 on classroom and dining hall hire and £150 on lunch. The booklet printing cost was £86. The expenses add up to nearly £402 plus miscellaneous items to be added like plates and cups etc. **This makes the overall deficit to be at least £132 at present.**

Finally ….
A big 'Thank You' to all teachers for attending this course and making it so successful with their participation, enthusiasm, encouragement and support.

I would also like to thank Shobhaben, Rekhaben, Chetanaben, Dipaben, Vijyaben Bhanderi and other colleagues for working so hard to prepare and deliver the course as well as to make arrangements for catering, serving and clearing up afterwards. I also thank Fullhurst Community College for their co-operation, support and for their excellent facilities.

Jayant Tanna
Chair
28th September 2025